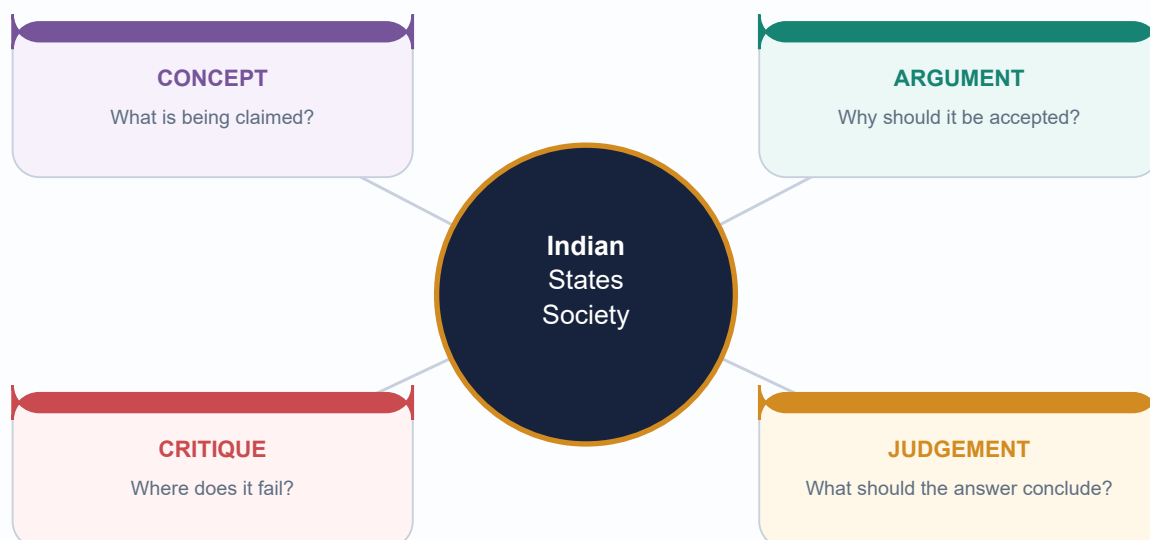


UPSC MODERN INDIAN HISTORY | PREMIUM SOLVED WORKBOOK

Indian States & Society in the Eighteenth Century - Solved Workbook

Modern Indian History Topic 02 | Prelims GS-I + GS-II
Evidence-led regional comparison | Complete teaching + practice
Generated 14 August 2026 | approved=false



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Workbook use and evidence rules

Prelims + GS-I
Modern Indian
History

INTRO & ORIGIN

This workbook contains every routed relevant PYQ, 48 hard MCQs, 12 remedials and three solved questions at each of 10, 15 and 20 marks.

STATIC THEORY

- Prelims answer keys unavailable locally are labelled INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY.
- The MCQ key rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D through all sixty questions.
- Every Mains solution follows claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation and ends with Why this earns marks.
- Use regional evidence regionally; do not convert Bengal, Delhi, Mysore or Punjab into an all-India aggregate.

MAINS ANGLE

Attempt questions before reading explanations; revise the relevant register heading after each error.

STUDY LINK

Main complete topic package, Parts I and final register.

HIGH

PYQ 01 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q48: eighteenth-century successor states

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Verified question: With reference to Indian history, which of the following statements is/are correct?

STATIC THEORY

- 1. The Nizamat of Arcot emerged out of Hyderabad State.
- 2. The Mysore Kingdom emerged out of Vijayanagara Empire.
- 3. Rohilkhand Kingdom was formed out of the territories occupied by Ahmad Shah Durrani.
- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 3 only
- **INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY:** B, 1 and 2 only. **Confidence:** high.
- **Solved explanation**
 - Statement 1 is correct in the conventional political genealogy: the Carnatic or Nizamat of Arcot developed within the Deccan-Hyderabad hierarchy before its Nawabs gained practical autonomy.
 - Statement 2 is correct: the Wodeyar kingdom of Mysore grew from the political field of the Vijayanagara Empire.
 - Statement 3 is incorrect: Rohilkhand grew from Afghan military settlement and weakening Mughal authority; Ahmad Shah Durrani later allied with Rohilla power but did not create the state from occupied territory.

- The question tests origin, not merely chronology. It distinguishes successor/subordinate formations from a later invader's sphere.

- **Why this earns marks:** It tests each statement independently, names the predecessor polity, corrects the backward projection of Durrani and labels the answer as inferred because the local official key is unavailable.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

PYQ 02 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q45: Mughal administrative hierarchy

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Verified question: With reference to medieval India, which one of the following is the correct sequence in ascending order in terms of size?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Pargana - Sarkar - Suba
- B. Sarkar - Pargana - Suba
- C. Suba - Sarkar - Pargana
- D. Pargana - Suba - Sarkar

- **INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY:** A, Pargana - Sarkar - Suba. **Confidence:** high.

- Solved explanation

- A pargana grouped villages and was the smaller revenue-administrative unit in this sequence.
- A sarkar grouped parganas.
- A subah was the larger province containing sarkars.
- The hierarchy matters for Topic 02 because regional states usually appropriated Mughal territorial and fiscal machinery rather than creating administration from nothing.
- **Why this earns marks:** It gives the exact ascending sequence and links the recall fact to institutional continuity, the analytical core of successor-state formation.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

PYQ 03 - 2022 GS-I Mains Q2: Company armies and Indian rulers

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Verified adjacent question: Why did the armies of the British East India Company - mostly comprising Indian soldiers - win consistently against the more numerous and better equipped armies of the then Indian rulers? Give reasons. (10 marks, 150 words)

STATIC THEORY

- **Routing note:** The direct owner is Modern History Topic 05. It is included here because Topic 02 explains the multi-state fiscal-military field from which the Company emerged. The answer must not treat fragmentation as automatic defeat.

- Model answer

- The Company's advantage lay less in the ethnicity of its soldiers than in the organisation that made them a reliable fiscal-military force. Indian states possessed capable cavalry, artillery and revenue systems: Mysore created French-trained infantry, Ibrahim Khan Gardi served the Marathas, and Ranjit Singh later built a disciplined army. The issue was consistency.

- The Company combined regular drill, infantry-artillery coordination, unified command and reliable payment. Coastal bases and the British naval network sustained supply. London credit and Indian bankers financed long campaigns, while diplomacy isolated opponents: Mysore, Maratha and Sikh forces were usually fought in separate wars with Indian allies on the Company side. After **Plassey (1757)** and especially the **Diwani (1765)**, Bengal revenue funded troops and further conquest.

- Yet victory was contingent: Haidar Ali reached Madras, the Treaty of Mangalore was negotiated, the First Anglo-Maratha War ended at Salbai, and Punjab remained independent under Ranjit Singh. The decisive edge was the cumulative integration of command, credit, revenue, supply and alliance, not inherent European superiority.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers "why" through linked mechanisms, uses named counter-evidence, distinguishes capability from identity and ends with a qualified causal verdict.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

PYQ coverage conclusion

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The audited repository routes one directly relevant successor-state Prelims question and one administrative-inheritance question. No direct GS-I Mains question confined to eighteenth-century regional states appears in the audited 2018-2025 route. The verified 2022 Company-armies question is therefore included only as an explicitly bounded bridge. No History Optional or unofficial coaching question is presented as a UPSC PYQ.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 01

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which classification best describes Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad in the eighteenth century?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Mughal successor states formed from provincial office
- B. Independent kingdoms outside Mughal institutions
- C. European client states from inception
- D. Uniform peasant republics
- **Answer:** A. Mughal successor states formed from provincial office
- **Explanation:** Their founders converted Mughal governorship and revenue office into practical autonomy while retaining imperial forms.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 02

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which evidence most directly shows practical autonomy without a formal break in Hyderabad?

STATIC THEORY

- A. A modern written constitution
- B. Independent war and appointments alongside coin and khutba in the emperor's name
- C. A permanent end to Mughal titles
- D. A ban on Persian administration
- **Answer:** B. Independent war and appointments alongside coin and khutba in the emperor's name
- **Explanation:** The contrast between autonomous action and retained symbolism is the defining evidence.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 03

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The Nizam of Arcot is best placed in which political genealogy?

STATIC THEORY

- A. A Rohilla state created by Durrani
- B. A Sikh misl on the Coromandel
- C. A Carnatic formation emerging from the Hyderabad-Deccan hierarchy
- D. A direct Portuguese province
- **Answer:** C. A Carnatic formation emerging from the Hyderabad-Deccan hierarchy
- **Explanation:** Arcot belonged to the Carnatic political field under Hyderabad before gaining practical autonomy.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 04

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: What does the emperor's name on a regional ruler's coin safely establish?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Daily fiscal control from Delhi
- B. Absence of a regional army
- C. Modern federal subordination
- D. A claim to Mughal legitimacy
- **Answer:** D. A claim to Mughal legitimacy
- **Explanation:** Coin legend is strong symbolic evidence but cannot by itself prove effective administration or remittance.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 05

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Who founded the autonomous Asaf Jahi line conventionally dated from 1724?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Nizam-ul-Mulk Asaf Jah I
- B. Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk
- C. Murshid Quli Khan
- D. Alivardi Khan
- **Answer:** A. Nizam-ul-Mulk Asaf Jah I

- **Explanation:** Nizam-ul-Mulk defeated Mubbariz Khan and consolidated Hyderabad in 1724.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 06

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: What was institutionally unusual about Murshid Quli Khan's position in Bengal in 1717?

STATIC THEORY

- A. He abolished land revenue
- B. He combined the offices of nazim and diwan
- C. He became Mughal emperor
- D. He transferred Bengal to Awadh
- **Answer:** B. He combined the offices of nazim and diwan

- **Explanation:** Combining executive and fiscal office weakened the older provincial check and strengthened autonomy.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 07

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Why was the house of Jagat Seth politically important in Bengal?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It commanded the Maratha confederacy
- B. It administered the Sikh misls
- C. It linked treasury, remittance, credit and mint influence
- D. It founded the Wodeyar dynasty
- **Answer:** C. It linked treasury, remittance, credit and mint influence
- **Explanation:** Banking power supported revenue remittance and coalition politics and later influenced succession.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 08

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which sequence correctly describes Bengal before Plassey?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Alivardi Khan - Murshid Quli Khan - Saadat Khan - Siraj
- B. Saadat Khan - Safdar Jang - Alivardi Khan - Mir Qasim
- C. Nizam-ul-Mulk - Sarfaraz Khan - Shuja-ud-Daula - Siraj
- D. Murshid Quli Khan - Shuja-ud-din - Alivardi Khan - Siraj-ud-Daula
- **Answer:** D. Murshid Quli Khan - Shuja-ud-din - Alivardi Khan - Siraj-ud-Daula
- **Explanation:** The sequence keeps Bengal's dynastic and military transitions distinct from Awadh and Hyderabad.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 09

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Who founded Awadh's autonomous provincial line after appointment as governor in 1722?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk

- B. Safdar Jang

- C. Shuja-ud-Daula

- D. Najib-ud-Daula

- **Answer:** A. Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk

- **Explanation:** Safdar Jang was Saadat Khan's successor and later imperial wazir.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 10

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which description best captures Awadh's treatment of major zamindars under Saadat Khan?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Universal dispossession and direct peasant ownership

- B. Military submission followed by confirmation when dues were accepted

- C. Complete zamindar independence

- D. Replacement by European collectors

- **Answer:** B. Military submission followed by confirmation when dues were accepted

- **Explanation:** Awadh centralised through controlled accommodation, not total abolition of local landed power.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 11

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: In Maratha fiscal language, chauth was primarily

STATIC THEORY

- A. a ten-percent superior deshmukh claim
- B. a village irrigation cess
- C. a one-fourth claim on assessed revenue, often outside the core territory
- D. a fixed salary to the Peshwa
- **Answer:** C. a one-fourth claim on assessed revenue, often outside the core territory
- **Explanation:** Chauth and sardeshmukhi were distinct claims and did not automatically equal direct sovereignty.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 12

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Sardeshmukhi is best distinguished from chauth as

STATIC THEORY

- A. the Mughal land survey
- B. a Sikh protection payment
- C. a European customs pass
- D. an additional one-tenth claim based on asserted superior deshmukh right
- **Answer:** D. an additional one-tenth claim based on asserted superior deshmukh right
- **Explanation:** The one-tenth sardeshmukhi claim was additional to the one-fourth chauth claim.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 13

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: What was the main significance of the 1719 Mughal-Maratha arrangement?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It used imperial sanction to recognise Shahu's swarajya and fiscal claims
- B. It abolished the Peshwaship
- C. It ended Maratha expansion permanently
- D. It transferred Delhi to Hyderabad
- **Answer:** A. It used imperial sanction to recognise Shahu's swarajya and fiscal claims
- **Explanation:** The arrangement joined Mughal legal form to expanding Maratha power and obligations.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 14

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The Battle of Palkhed (1728) is associated with

STATIC THEORY

- A. Abdali defeating the Marathas
- B. Bajji Rao I compelling Nizam-ul-Mulk to reaffirm Shahu's Deccan claims
- C. Alivardi defeating the Company
- D. Haidar Ali defeating the Dutch
- **Answer:** B. Bajji Rao I compelling Nizam-ul-Mulk to reaffirm Shahu's Deccan claims
- **Explanation:** Palkhed strengthened Bajji Rao and Shahu but did not settle all Deccan rivalry.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 15

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which pairing of Maratha house and regional base is correct?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Holkar - Bengal
- B. Scindia - Travancore
- C. Gaekwad - Baroda/Gujarat
- D. Bhonsle - Arcot

- **Answer:** C. Gaekwad - Baroda/Gujarat

- **Explanation:** Holkar centred on Indore/Malwa, Scindia on Gwalior/north India and Bhonsle on Nagpur/eastward expansion.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 16

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Baji Rao I's expansion into Malwa and Gujarat was strategically important because it

STATIC THEORY

- A. ended the need for revenue collection
- B. created a unitary national state
- C. removed all local zamindars
- D. provided resources and placed pressure between Hyderabad and Delhi

- **Answer:** D. provided resources and placed pressure between Hyderabad and Delhi

- **Explanation:** The provinces offered wealth, routes and strategic depth; local rights and negotiation remained.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 17

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which power was an important ally of Ahmad Shah Abdali at Panipat?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Najib-ud-Daula of Rohilkhand
- B. Suraj Mal as a committed Maratha commander
- C. Murshid Quli Khan
- D. Martanda Varma

- **Answer:** A. Najib-ud-Daula of Rohilkhand

- **Explanation:** Abdali's coalition included Rohilla support and Shuja-ud-Daula; Maratha relations with likely northern allies had deteriorated.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 18

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The most accurate assessment of Panipat (1761) is that it

STATIC THEORY

- A. created permanent Afghan rule in India
- B. severely damaged Maratha northern power but did not end Maratha recovery
- C. immediately established Company rule across India
- D. abolished the Peshwaship

- **Answer:** B. severely damaged Maratha northern power but did not end Maratha recovery

- **Explanation:** Madhav Rao restored power and Marathas returned Shah Alam II to Delhi in 1771.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 19

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which event best demonstrates post-Panipat Maratha recovery?

STATIC THEORY

- A. The 1717 Bengal appointment
- B. The execution of Banda in 1716
- C. Restoration of Shah Alam II to Delhi in 1771
- D. The founding of Jaipur in 1727
- **Answer:** C. Restoration of Shah Alam II to Delhi in 1771
- **Explanation:** The 1771 action shows renewed northern reach under the recovered confederacy.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 20

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Why is the Shahu-Tarabai contest important?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It was a British annexation dispute
- B. It created the Khalsa
- C. It ended local hereditary rights
- D. It enabled sardars and the Peshwa to bargain and reshape Maratha authority
- **Answer:** D. It enabled sardars and the Peshwa to bargain and reshape Maratha authority
- **Explanation:** The contest weakened simple dynastic command and helped produce a negotiated Peshwa-centred order.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 21

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The Khalsa was established by Guru Gobind Singh in

STATIC THEORY

- A. 1699

- B. 1707

- C. 1719

- D. 1761

- **Answer:** A. 1699

- **Explanation:** The 1699 foundation is the institutional legacy for eighteenth-century Sikh mobilisation.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 22

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which act most clearly shows Banda Singh Bahadur moving from revolt toward state formation?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Joining the English Company

- B. Appointing officials and using coin and seal

- C. Accepting the Peshwaship

- D. Founding Hyderabad

- **Answer:** B. Appointing officials and using coin and seal

- **Explanation:** Faujdars, diwan, kardars, coin and seal are administrative and sovereign practices.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 23

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement about Banda Singh Bahadur's social base is most accurate?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Every Khatri merchant supported him
- B. Only Mughal nobles supported him
- C. It included Jat peasants and smaller zamindars but was not socially unanimous
- D. It had no agrarian dimension
- **Answer:** C. It included Jat peasants and smaller zamindars but was not socially unanimous
- **Explanation:** Peasant, zamindar and commercial interests varied, and some groups aligned with the Mughals.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 24

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: How should the number of Sikh misls be written in an evidence-disciplined answer?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Exactly twelve unchanging units from 1699
- B. No misls existed before 1809
- C. All bands were provinces of Awadh
- D. Twelve major misls in conventional classification, with fluid contemporary groupings
- **Answer:** D. Twelve major misls in conventional classification, with fluid contemporary groupings
- **Explanation:** The textbook twelve is useful, but boundaries and the count of territorial combinations changed over time.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 25

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The Dal Khalsa represented

STATIC THEORY

- A. collective Sikh mobilisation above individual misls
- B. the Bengal treasury
- C. the Mughal revenue ministry
- D. the Maratha royal council

- **Answer:** A. collective Sikh mobilisation above individual misls

- **Explanation:** It allowed joint action without eliminating misl autonomy.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 26

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Why is Ranjit Singh bounded in this topic?

STATIC THEORY

- A. He founded the Khalsa in 1699
- B. He represents late-century consolidation after the misl phase
- C. He fought at Panipat in 1761
- D. He created Rohilkhand

- **Answer:** B. He represents late-century consolidation after the misl phase

- **Explanation:** His capture of Lahore in 1799 completes a trajectory; his mature state and Anglo-Sikh context belong later.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 27

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The Mysore kingdom's historical genealogy is most closely linked to

STATIC THEORY

- A. the Durrani Empire
- B. the Sikh misls
- C. the Vijayanagara political order
- D. the Portuguese Estado da India

- **Answer:** C. the Vijayanagara political order

- **Explanation:** The Wodeyar kingdom emerged from the post-Vijayanagara regional field.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 28

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which reform is associated with Haidar Ali's military consolidation?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Abolition of all land taxes
- B. Creation of the Jagat Seth bank
- C. The 1719 Maratha sanad
- D. A modern arsenal at Dindigul with French assistance

- **Answer:** D. A modern arsenal at Dindigul with French assistance

- **Explanation:** The Dindigul arsenal and trained units strengthened Mysore's military capability.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 29

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Tipu Sultan's later use of his own name in coinage and khutba most strongly indicates

STATIC THEORY

- A. a sharper assertion of sovereignty than most successor states
- B. direct Mughal control
- C. membership in the Dal Khalsa
- D. submission to the Peshwa

- **Answer:** A. a sharper assertion of sovereignty than most successor states

- **Explanation:** The symbolism marked a more explicit claim, though even Tipu used Mughal authority pragmatically when useful.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 30

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Martanda Varma strengthened Travancore mainly through

STATIC THEORY

- A. Mughal mansabdari alone
- B. military centralisation, trade monopoly and public works
- C. Sikh conquest shares
- D. Company Diwani

- **Answer:** B. military centralisation, trade monopoly and public works

- **Explanation:** Army reform, suppression of feudatories, pepper revenue and communication works reinforced the state.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 31

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Who consolidated the Jat kingdom of Bharatpur at its eighteenth-century height?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Churaman alone
- B. Najib-ud-Daula
- C. Suraj Mal
- D. Nizam Ali Khan

- **Answer:** C. Suraj Mal

- **Explanation:** Churaman and Badan Singh built the state; Suraj Mal expanded and centralised it.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 32

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Sawai Jai Singh II is correctly associated with

STATIC THEORY

- A. the Bhangi misl
- B. Murshidabad's mint
- C. the Treaty of Mangalore
- D. Jaipur and monumental astronomical observatories

- **Answer:** D. Jaipur and monumental astronomical observatories

- **Explanation:** Jaipur and Jantar Mantar provide a counter-example to blanket cultural or scientific sterility.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 33

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Rohilkhand emerged primarily from

STATIC THEORY

- A. Afghan military settlement amid Mughal weakening

- B. territory occupied and granted by Durrani

- C. a Portuguese coastal factory

- D. a Travancore succession

- **Answer:** A. Afghan military settlement amid Mughal weakening

- **Explanation:** Durrani later allied with Rohillas; he did not found their state.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 34

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The phrase military labour market refers to

STATIC THEORY

- A. a permanent caste with one ruler only

- B. mobile soldiers and commanders offering service across competing courts

- C. European troops alone

- D. unpaid village police

- **Answer:** B. mobile soldiers and commanders offering service across competing courts

- **Explanation:** Afghans, Rajputs, Marathas, artillerymen and others moved through service networks shaped by pay and patronage.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 35

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Ijara or ijaradari was

STATIC THEORY

- A. a Sikh initiation rite
- B. a Mughal coin legend
- C. revenue farming to a contractor for a fixed promised sum
- D. a Maratha fort category
- **Answer:** C. revenue farming to a contractor for a fixed promised sum
- **Explanation:** It supplied quick cash but could intensify extraction and empower financier-collectors.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 36

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Peshkash most commonly denoted

STATIC THEORY

- A. a village share of chauth
- B. an artillery drill
- C. a European sea pass
- D. tribute or payment acknowledging a superior authority
- **Answer:** D. tribute or payment acknowledging a superior authority
- **Explanation:** Peshkash could preserve a hierarchical relationship without direct daily administration.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 37

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: What is the most accurate description of the banker-state-company relationship?

STATIC THEORY

- A. A shifting triangle of credit, security, trade privilege and political leverage
- B. Bankers always served the Company
- C. States did not need credit
- D. Companies had no Indian partners
- **Answer:** A. A shifting triangle of credit, security, trade privilege and political leverage
- **Explanation:** Bankers pursued repayment and access; their alignments varied by region and political moment.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 38

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: A hundi was important because it

STATIC THEORY

- A. served as a fort cannon
- B. transferred credit and remittance across commercial networks
- C. abolished customs
- D. defined a Sikh misl
- **Answer:** B. transferred credit and remittance across commercial networks
- **Explanation:** Hundis helped move revenue, settle accounts and finance trade and war.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 39

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which set contains important eighteenth-century textile or craft centres?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Panipat battlefield, Palkhed, Karnal and Plassey
- B. Lahore fort, Raigad, Arcot and Rohilkhand only
- C. Dacca, Murshidabad, Banaras and Masulipatnam
- D. Anandpur, Satara, Kabul and Mangalore only

- **Answer:** C. Dacca, Murshidabad, Banaras and Masulipatnam

- **Explanation:** Manufacturing centres were distributed across several commercial regions.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 40

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: What happened to Bengal's trade under Maratha pressure and European expansion?

STATIC THEORY

- A. All trade ended permanently
- B. Only inland trade grew
- C. European companies withdrew
- D. Some overland trade suffered while oceanic European trade expanded

- **Answer:** D. Some overland trade suffered while oceanic European trade expanded

- **Explanation:** The divergent routes illustrate why one aggregate decline claim is unsafe.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 41

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement best captures caste and mobility in the century?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Hierarchy remained strong, but service could raise selected individuals and lineages
- B. Caste disappeared under regional states
- C. No social mobility existed
- D. Political power always followed ritual rank
- **Answer:** A. Hierarchy remained strong, but service could raise selected individuals and lineages
- **Explanation:** The rise of houses such as Holkar shows mobility within, not abolition of, hierarchy.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 42

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Why must women's history be written with explicit source limits?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Women left no historical evidence at all
- B. Elite and spectacular practices are over-recorded relative to ordinary labour
- C. All regions followed one matrilineal system
- D. Court chronicles provide full village data
- **Answer:** B. Elite and spectacular practices are over-recorded relative to ordinary labour
- **Explanation:** Tarabai and Ahilyabai are visible, but ordinary agricultural and craft work is less fully documented.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 43

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement about eighteenth-century political alliances is most accurate?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Hindus and Muslims never allied
- B. All wars were religious
- C. Revenue, strategy and faction usually mattered more than communal blocs
- D. Only Europeans crossed religious lines
- **Answer:** C. Revenue, strategy and faction usually mattered more than communal blocs
- **Explanation:** Awadh-Maratha-Jat cooperation and Abdali's alliance with Rohillas and Awadh demonstrate cross-religious strategy.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 44

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The migration of artists from Delhi to regional courts best supports which argument?

STATIC THEORY

- A. All Mughal art ended in 1707
- B. Regional culture had no Persianate influence
- C. Only European art survived
- D. Patronage was redistributed rather than uniformly extinguished
- **Answer:** D. Patronage was redistributed rather than uniformly extinguished
- **Explanation:** Regional schools and courts gained talent as the imperial centre lost exclusivity.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 45

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which phrase best describes institutional change in successor states?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Continuity of grammar, change of authorship
- B. Complete administrative invention
- C. Unchanged direct rule from Delhi
- D. Modern federalism

- **Answer:** A. Continuity of grammar, change of authorship

- **Explanation:** Old vocabulary and forms survived while regional rulers, elites and financiers controlled them.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 46

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which is a genuine institutional innovation of the century?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Abolition of all intermediaries everywhere
- B. Misl conquest shares and selective direct revenue systems in Mysore
- C. The disappearance of coinage
- D. Uniform parliamentary government

- **Answer:** B. Misl conquest shares and selective direct revenue systems in Mysore

- **Explanation:** Regional states adapted old systems and introduced new coalition or collection mechanisms.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 47

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: A fiscal-military state is one that

STATIC THEORY

- A. separates taxation from war completely
- B. depends only on ritual authority
- C. turns revenue and credit into sustained military capacity
- D. has no merchants or officials
- **Answer:** C. turns revenue and credit into sustained military capacity
- **Explanation:** The revenue-army-revenue loop is central to Mysore, Awadh, Maratha and Company power.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 48

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which factor most clearly distinguished the Company's later fiscal-military system?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Exclusive use of European soldiers
- B. Absence of Indian bankers
- C. No reliance on alliances
- D. Integration of territorial revenue, corporate credit, unified command and maritime supply
- **Answer:** D. Integration of territorial revenue, corporate credit, unified command and maritime supply
- **Explanation:** The Company relied heavily on Indian sepoys, credit and allies but integrated them through a durable corporate-state structure.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 49

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement about Panipat is the correct remedial rule?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It checked a northern bid but Maratha power recovered
- B. It ended all Maratha states
- C. It made Abdali emperor of India
- D. It immediately gave the Company the Deccan
- **Answer:** A. It checked a northern bid but Maratha power recovered
- **Explanation:** Never use Panipat as the terminal date of Maratha political power.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 50

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement about successor-state sovereignty is correct?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Every governor issued a declaration of national independence
- B. Practical independence could coexist with Mughal coin, khutba and titles
- C. Mughal symbols prove full Delhi control
- D. All successor states abolished Persian
- **Answer:** B. Practical independence could coexist with Mughal coin, khutba and titles
- **Explanation:** Separate formal symbolism from effective appointments, revenue and war.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 51

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which is the correct chauth trap correction?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It was identical to sardeshmukhi
- B. It was paid only by Maratha peasants
- C. It was a fiscal claim, not ordinary direct land tax or automatic territorial rule
- D. It was a Sikh protection tax
- **Answer:** C. It was a fiscal claim, not ordinary direct land tax or automatic territorial rule
- **Explanation:** The nature and collection of the claim varied and often preceded administration.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 52

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which sequence corrects the common Sikh chronology trap?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Ranjit Singh - Khalsa - Banda - misls
- B. Banda - Guru Nanak - Ranjit - Khalsa
- C. Misls - Khalsa - Banda - Guru Gobind Singh
- D. Khalsa - Banda Singh Bahadur - misls - Ranjit Singh
- **Answer:** D. Khalsa - Banda Singh Bahadur - misls - Ranjit Singh
- **Explanation:** Do not begin Sikh political history with Ranjit Singh.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 53

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which classification correction is essential for Mysore?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It was an older southern regional kingdom, not a Mughal successor province
- B. It emerged from Rohilkhand
- C. It was a Maratha house
- D. It was created by the Company
- **Answer:** A. It was an older southern regional kingdom, not a Mughal successor province
- **Explanation:** Mysore's genealogy runs through Vijayanagara and the Wodeyars.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 54

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Can Bengal's commercial strength prove all-India prosperity?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Yes; one surplus province fixes the national trend
- B. No; regional evidence requires regional conclusions
- C. Yes; war therefore had no cost
- D. No; because Bengal had no trade
- **Answer:** B. No; regional evidence requires regional conclusions
- **Explanation:** The correct method is regional comparison, not aggregate projection.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 55

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement about Jagat Seth is safest?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It founded the East India Company
- B. It commanded Abdali's army
- C. The banking house served regional fiscal power and pursued its interests; it was not a timeless Company agent
- D. It had no relation to the Bengal treasury
- **Answer:** C. The banking house served regional fiscal power and pursued its interests; it was not a timeless Company agent
- **Explanation:** Banking alignments changed with security, repayment and factional politics.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 56

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: What is the correct coin-and-khutba inference?

STATIC THEORY

- A. They give exact revenue totals
- B. They prove a ruler had no army
- C. They prove national sovereignty
- D. They show legitimacy claims, not the full reach of administration
- **Answer:** D. They show legitimacy claims, not the full reach of administration
- **Explanation:** Symbolic evidence must be paired with appointments, remittance, war and treaties.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 57

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement corrects the 'Maratha nation' overstatement?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Maratha power was socially and regionally diverse and confederate
- B. Every chief obeyed one central bureaucracy
- C. Religion alone determined alliances
- D. Local watan rights disappeared
- **Answer:** A. Maratha power was socially and regionally diverse and confederate
- **Explanation:** Use polity, confederacy and regional mobilisation rather than modern national homogeneity.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 58

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement corrects a uniform claim about women?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Purdah was identical across India
- B. Class, caste, labour and region produced sharply different experiences
- C. All widows could remarry
- D. Elite rulers represent all women
- **Answer:** B. Class, caste, labour and region produced sharply different experiences
- **Explanation:** State the source base and distinguish elite visibility from ordinary work.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 59

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement corrects the 'trade collapse' trap?

STATIC THEORY

- A. All internal and external trade stopped
- B. No artisan centre survived
- C. Routes and towns experienced different decline, recovery and growth
- D. Only Delhi mattered
- **Answer:** C. Routes and towns experienced different decline, recovery and growth
- **Explanation:** War hurt some corridors while oceanic trade and regional centres expanded elsewhere.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 60

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement corrects the inevitability trap?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Mughal decline automatically caused British rule
- B. Panipat transferred sovereignty to Britain
- C. Indian rulers never defeated Company forces
- D. Fragmentation created openings, but Company victory required later revenue, credit, alliances and war
- **Answer:** D. Fragmentation created openings, but Company victory required later revenue, credit, alliances and war
- **Explanation:** Opportunity is not destiny; the sequence from commerce to fiscal-military state must be demonstrated.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 10M-1 - Classify the major eighteenth-century Indian states and explain why the classification matters. (150 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Eighteenth-century states are best classified by **origin and legitimacy**, not by a simple strong/weak scale.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Mughal successor states** - Bengal under Murshid Quli Khan, Awadh under Saadat Khan and Hyderabad under Nizam-ul-Mulk - converted provincial office into hereditary autonomy. They retained Mughal titles, Persian administration and often coin/khutba symbolism, but controlled appointments, revenue and war locally.

- **Resistance or confederate states** - Marathas, Sikhs, Jats and Rohillas - grew through armed mobilisation, local landed groups and new fiscal claims. The 1719 Maratha sanads legalised chauth/sardeshmukhi, while Banda Singh Bahadur's officials, coin and seal and the later Sikh misls reveal different routes from resistance to rule.

- **Older autonomous regional kingdoms** - Mysore, Travancore and major Rajput states - strengthened pre-existing polities. Haidar Ali's arsenal and Martanda Varma's army and pepper monopoly show more explicit centralisation.

- The classification matters because origin shaped political resources and weaknesses: successor states borrowed imperial legitimacy, confederacies traded unity for reach, and older kingdoms could innovate but still had to bargain with local elites. It therefore explains both regional vitality and the absence of one uncontested Mughal replacement.

- **Why this earns marks:** It defines the classification criterion, names three evidence-rich categories, analyses why origin mattered and avoids equating autonomy with modern nation-state sovereignty.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 10M-2 - Hyderabad represented continuity in form and autonomy in substance. Examine. (150 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Hyderabad under **Nizam-ul-Mulk Asaf Jah I** illustrates how Mughal political grammar survived after imperial command weakened.

STATIC THEORY**- Model answer**

- **Continuity in form** remained visible in coins struck in the emperor's name, the emperor's place in the khutba, Persian chancery practice and the continued use of mansab, jagir and peshkash. These forms gave a former imperial noble recognised legitimacy among Deccan chiefs and service elites.

- **Autonomy in substance** followed the defeat of Mubariz Khan and consolidation in **1724**. Asaf Jah conducted wars and treaties, conferred mansabs and made major appointments without seeking effective approval from Delhi. Revenue served the Hyderabad treasury and army; local rulers paid tribute to the Nizam.

- Yet the state was not fully centralised. Bandyopadhyay notes that traders, moneylenders, military aristocrats and revenue farmers remained powerful; jagirs became more hereditary and power stayed widely diffused. Post-1748 succession conflict further exposed this limitation.

- Thus Hyderabad was neither a loyal province nor a modern sovereign nation-state. It was a regional patron-client order that used Mughal symbolism to legitimise practical independence.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers both halves of the formulation, uses coin/khutba and independent appointments as paired evidence, and qualifies autonomy with the state's diffused internal structure.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 10M-3 - The Third Battle of Panipat was a grave Maratha setback, not the end of Maratha power. Explain. (150 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Panipat on **14 January 1761** destroyed a major Maratha expeditionary force and sharply reduced Peshwa prestige, but it did not terminate Maratha power.

STATIC THEORY**- Model answer**

- The setback was strategic. **Sadashiv Rao Bhau**, Vishwas Rao and many experienced commanders were lost; long supply lines, factional command and damaged relations with Rajputs, Jats and Sikh chiefs left the army isolated. **Ahmad Shah Abdali**, by contrast, secured Rohilla support and Shuja-ud-Daula's alliance. The defeat therefore exposed coalition and logistics failure rather than the absence of trained infantry: **Ibrahim Khan Gardi** commanded a European-style force.

- Its limits are equally clear. Abdali did not establish durable Indian rule. Under **Madhav Rao I (1761-72)** the Marathas defeated the Nizam, pressured Haidar Ali and recovered north Indian influence. In **1771** they restored Shah Alam II to Delhi. Later Scindia power again dominated imperial politics.

- Panipat ended the immediate bid for northern paramountcy and created openings for rivals, including the Company. It did not abolish the confederacy; the decisive British-Maratha struggle still lay ahead.

- **Why this earns marks:** It separates battlefield loss, political consequence and later recovery, names commanders and the 1771 evidence, and rejects both terminal and inevitability claims.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 15M-1 - Compare state formation in Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad. (250 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad were all Mughal successor states, but they converted provincial office into autonomy through different coalitions and regional constraints.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Common inheritance:** Each founder was an imperial servant. Murshid Quli Khan in Bengal, Saadat Khan in Awadh and Nizam-ul-Mulk in Hyderabad retained Persian administration, titles and Mughal legitimacy. None began with a modern declaration of independence. Their common mechanism was to redirect provincial revenue, appointments and military force from Delhi toward a regional treasury and dynasty.

- **Bengal - fiscal-commercial coalition:** Murshid Quli combined nazim and diwan authority in 1717, enforced revenue through large zamindars and sustained remittance. Commerce in textiles and oceanic trade elevated merchants and bankers; the **Jagat Seth** house became provincial treasurer in 1730. Alivardi Khan's rise with landed and banking support shows both strength and coalition dependence. Maratha raids and growing European privilege were the major vulnerabilities.

- **Awadh - landed-military accommodation:** Saadat Khan subdued rebellious zamindars but usually confirmed them after securing payment. A provincial fiscal establishment detached revenue from Delhi, while Indian Muslim, Afghan and Hindu elites and a rich military labour market supported the state. Safdar Jang's use of Maratha and Jat allies shows pragmatic coalition-building. Refractory chiefs remained a recurring constraint.

- **Hyderabad - patron-client Deccan order:** Asaf Jah's victory in 1724 created practical autonomy while coin and khutba retained the emperor. Local chiefs paid peshkash; traders, moneylenders, revenue farmers and military aristocrats remained co-sharers. Diffused authority and post-1748 succession conflict limited centralisation.

- Therefore the three shared Mughal institutional grammar but differed in social base: Bengal was most commercially financed, Awadh most dependent on landed-military accommodation, and Hyderabad most visibly a diffused Deccan patron-client system.

- **Why this earns marks:** It compares through common criteria - legitimacy, revenue, elite coalition and weakness - rather than narrating three states separately, and uses named institutions and bankers.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 15M-2 - Assess the Maratha polity under the Peshwas as a fiscal-military confederacy. (250 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Under the Peshwas the Maratha polity became a far-reaching fiscal-military confederacy: its decentralisation enabled expansion but obstructed stable paramountcy.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Fiscal foundation:** The **1719 sanads** recognised Shahu's swarajya and claims to **chauth** and **sardeshmukhi** in the Deccan. Balaji Vishwanath distributed collection spheres among sardars, who retained large shares to maintain troops. This converted military initiative into recurring fiscal claims, but also made the Raja and Peshwa dependent on autonomous collectors.

- **Political centre:** **Baji Rao I (1720-40)** made the Peshwaship hereditary in practice and the focal point of patronage. Palkhed (1728) checked Nizam-ul-Mulk, while expansion into Malwa and Gujarat added resources and strategic depth. After Shahu's death in 1749, Nana Saheb shifted effective government to Poona.

- **Confederate structure:** Gaekwad, Holkar, Scindia and Bhonsle houses built personal armies and regional fiscal bases. In core areas civilian revenue officers developed more regular administration; elsewhere tribute and negotiated rights preceded direct governance. Watan and deshmukh rights survived, while saranjams rewarded service.

- **Strength:** The system mobilised cavalry and local entrepreneurship over a vast area at relatively low central cost. It adapted Mughal legal vocabulary and employed trained infantry and artillery, as shown by Ibrahim Khan Gardi.

- **Weakness:** Rival houses, uneven remittance, thin administration and poor coalition management undermined unified strategy at Panipat. Yet Madhav Rao's recovery and the restoration of Shah Alam II in 1771 show that confederacy was not simple collapse.

- The Maratha order was therefore neither a unitary empire nor mere raiding. It was an effective expansion system whose fiscal decentralisation outpaced political integration.

- **Why this earns marks:** It connects revenue measures to armies and houses, balances efficiency with strategic cost, and uses 1719, Palkhed, Panipat and 1771 as a causal sequence.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 15M-3 - Trace Sikh political transformation from the Khalsa to the misls. (250 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Sikh political transformation in the eighteenth century was a non-linear movement from disciplined community to territorial revolt and then to decentralised confederate power.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Khalsa foundation:** In **1699**, Guru Gobind Singh established the Khalsa, using initiation and visible discipline to strengthen a distinctive armed community. After his death in 1708, authority was located in the Panth and Granth traditions rather than another personal Guru. Not all Sikhs were Khalsa, and Jat peasants, Khatri traders and other groups had different interests.

- **Banda Singh Bahadur:** Banda mobilised many Jat peasants and smaller zamindars under severe fiscal pressure. His movement crossed the line from rebellion toward state formation: he appointed faujdars, a diwan and kardars, issued orders under a seal and minted coin. Yet support was uneven. Some Jat zamindars and Khatri commercial-revenue interests sided with Mughal authority. Mughal pressure and internal division culminated in his capture in 1715 and execution in 1716.

- **Misl phase:** Sikh bands survived persecution and expanded amid the disruption caused by Nadir Shah and Ahmad Shah Abdali. Territorial gains were distributed in pattis according to contribution. The later conventional classification identifies twelve major misls, but contemporary combinations were fluid. The **Dal Khalsa** enabled collective action above individual misls without abolishing chiefly autonomy.

- **Direction of change:** The order mixed an egalitarian co-sharing ideal with the growing power of chiefs. This decentralised structure resisted Afghan control but could not produce permanent unified command. Ranjit Singh's capture of Lahore in 1799 therefore marks a later turn toward monarchy, not the starting point of Sikh politics.

- **Why this earns marks:** It traces institutions and social bases rather than a ruler list, reconciles the twelve-misl shorthand with source fluidity, and keeps Ranjit Singh within a clear boundary.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 20M-1 - Was the eighteenth century a dark age, a transition or an age of regional resurgence? Critically discuss. (250 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

No single label fits the eighteenth century because political, economic, social and cultural change moved at different speeds and varied sharply by region.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Why "dark age" has force:** Mughal central command contracted; Nadir Shah and Abdali exposed frontier weakness; Panipat destroyed an experienced Maratha force; Bengal faced repeated Maratha raids; revenue farming and armies increased pressure on cultivators. Delhi, Lahore, Mathura, Surat and other centres suffered episodes of plunder. Older imperial histories rightly identify real war, fiscal stress and insecurity.

- **Why it is insufficient:** Regional states retained capacity. Murshid Quli Khan's Bengal maintained a powerful revenue-commercial coalition; Saadat Khan and Safdar Jang consolidated Awadh; Asaf Jah made Hyderabad autonomous; Haidar Ali built an arsenal and disciplined army; Martanda Varma combined military reform with pepper revenue and public works. Jaipur's planned city and Jantar Mantar and the shift of artists to Lucknow, Hyderabad and other courts show cultural vitality.

- **Transition in institutions:** Mughal forms survived even where Mughal control did not. Coin and khutba, Persian chancery, nazim-diwan offices, jagir, zamindar and revenue vocabulary continued, but regional rulers, bankers and local elites controlled them. Maratha chauth/sardeshmukhi, Sikh misls and Mysore's direct revenue experiments also changed the content of state power.

- **Regional resurgence with social limits:** Trade, textiles, hundi finance and oceanic commerce remained vigorous in several zones. Yet a prosperous Bengal merchant or Mysore cultivator cannot stand for all India. Peasants, artisans and women experienced outcomes according to war corridor, caste, tenure and patronage.

- **Historiography:** Materialist interpretations explain agrarian and jagirdari stress; regional and revisionist work by Muzaffar Alam, C.A. Bayly and others explains new provincial wealth and coalitions. Each is strongest at a different scale.

- The graded verdict is therefore: **crisis of imperial centralisation, transition of institutions, and selective regional resurgence under unequal social conditions.**

- **Why this earns marks:** It tests all three labels across dimensions, uses eight named regional examples, represents competing historiographies fairly and gives a scale-specific verdict rather than an artificial compromise.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 20M-2 - Examine society and economy in eighteenth-century India with attention to regional variation. (250 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Eighteenth-century society and economy combined commercial resilience with fiscal coercion and durable hierarchy; regional evidence does not support either nationwide collapse or nationwide prosperity.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Agriculture and revenue:** Cultivation remained the chief revenue base. In Bengal, Awadh-Banaras and parts of the south, reclamation, monetisation and surplus supported states. Yet zamindars, jagirdars, revenue farmers and officials competed over the cultivator's surplus. War, ijara and irregular exactions could worsen insecurity even where output grew. Productivity and peasant welfare must therefore be separated.

- **Crafts and towns:** Cotton and silk textiles, saltpetre, indigo, arms, metalwork and shipbuilding remained significant. Dacca, Murshidabad, Patna, Banaras, Lucknow, Masulipatnam and southern centres continued production. Some older cities and routes suffered plunder, while new regional capitals such as Lucknow, Poona, Jaipur and Hyderabad attracted artisans and officials. Urban change was redistribution, not a single decline curve.

- **Trade and finance:** European companies imported bullion for Indian goods and expanded oceanic commerce, while Hindu, Muslim and Armenian merchants remained important. The Jagat Seth house linked Bengal's treasury, mint and remittance; hundis moved credit across regions. But European fortified factories and privilege gave commerce an increasingly coercive political edge.

- **Social structure:** Zamindars ranged from local intermediaries to rajas; peasants were differentiated by rights and resources. Caste remained strong, though military and fiscal service enabled mobility, as the Holkar rise shows. Muslim society also had status, sect and occupational hierarchy. Tarabai and Ahilyabai reveal elite female agency, while peasant women worked in fields and crafts; neither evidence justifies a uniform gender claim.

- **Culture and community:** Cross-religious service and shared Persianate-vernacular worlds continued, but "composite culture" did not erase caste or elite control.

- Thus the economy was regionally resilient and socially unequal: state formation created markets and careers while often transferring its fiscal cost downward.

- **Why this earns marks:** It integrates agriculture, crafts, finance, towns, caste and gender; names regional evidence; and repeatedly qualifies aggregate claims and source visibility.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 20M-3 - How did eighteenth-century state formation prepare the ground for Company expansion without making conquest inevitable? (250 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Eighteenth-century state formation created a competitive fiscal-military field into which European companies could enter, but Company conquest required later, contingent advantages.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Openings created by regional politics:** Succession disputes in Hyderabad and the Carnatic allowed French and English companies to sell troops and install clients. Bengal's Nawabs confronted fortified factories and the abuse of the 1717 trade privilege. Maratha, Awadh, Rohilla and Rajput rivalries produced repeated alliance markets. Mobile sepoys, gunners and commanders and Indian bankers made military intervention possible.

- **Financial connection:** Regional states depended on credit, remittance and revenue contractors. The Jagat Seths in Bengal and hundi networks demonstrate the centrality of finance. Companies entered this world as merchants and creditors, then combined contracts with armed force.

- **Company differentiation:** Its later advantage was cumulative integration: unified command, regular payment, artillery-infantry drill, coastal supply, British naval protection, London and Indian credit, and diplomacy that isolated opponents. After Plassey and especially the **Diwani of 1765**, Bengal revenue financed purchases and new wars, turning a company into a territorial fiscal-military state.

- **Why defeat was not predetermined:** Indian states adapted. Haidar Ali created a modern arsenal and defeated Company forces; the Second Anglo-Mysore War ended at the Treaty of Mangalore. The First Anglo-Maratha War ended in the negotiated Treaty of Salbai, and Punjab remained independent under Ranjit Singh. Panipat did not transfer India to Britain.

- **Structural weakness without teleology:** Confederacies faced coordination problems, successor states depended on elite coalitions, and no stable all-India alliance emerged. Yet these were vulnerabilities, not a timetable for conquest.

- Therefore regionalisation supplied opportunities and Indian resources, while British supremacy resulted from specific victories, Bengal finance, corporate-state organisation and Indian collaboration. The bridge was real; inevitability was not.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers both the enabling and anti-inevitability halves, names succession, banking, Diwani and Indian counter-successes, and explains mechanism rather than moralising about unity.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.